# Capecitabine + rectal radiotherapy

Capecitabine tablets help pelvic radiotherapy work against locally advanced rectal cancer. Your team explains how this course fits with surgery and any other chemotherapy.

**Locally advanced rectal cancer with concurrent radiotherapy** · NCCP 00586 v3 · Document revised 4 November 2026

**Your personal plan:** this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

## My overall treatment

Take capecitabine twice daily on Days 1–5 of each 7-day cycle with radiotherapy, for a maximum of 5–6 cycles. Days 6–7 are not routine tablet days. Follow the team's written instructions if radiotherapy or tablets are interrupted.

**Weekly chemoradiation**
Capecitabine twice daily on Days 1–5 of each 7-day cycle, alongside radiotherapy, for up to 5–6 cycles. Follow the written plan for treatment days and interruptions.

**Review**
Course length, response scans and next steps follow your individual plan.

## A typical 7-day cycle

| Day 1–5 | Day 6–7 |
|---|---|
| Treatment days | Planned tablet-free days |

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

## My tests and checks

| When | What is checked | Timing / reason |
|---|---|---|
| **Before** | **DPD and baseline bloods**<br>Required by regimen | Confirm DPD testing, blood count, kidney and liver results before starting. |
| **During** | **Blood count / kidneys / liver**<br>Required by regimen | Before each weekly cycle. Review symptoms and medicines. |
| **After / review** | **Recovery, scans / markers**<br>Team-agreed plan | Follow the individual cancer plan; this regimen does not prescribe a universal scan or marker interval. |

## Between treatments

- Report fever, sudden illness, diarrhoea, mouth pain or poor intake promptly.
- Symptoms can occur during treatment, between visits and after completion.

Confirm your prescription, supportive medicines, tests and working contact numbers.

**When to get help**

**Call 112 / 999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

**Call oncology immediately:** temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.**



Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

# What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

### 1 Mouth

**Capecitabine**

Painful ulcers or reduced intake: stop tablets and call.

### 2 Chest

**Capecitabine**

New chest pain: stop tablets and seek urgent assessment.

### 3 Bowel / stoma

**Capecitabine + radiotherapy**

Significant diarrhoea, increased output or dehydration needs prompt advice.

### 4 Hands / feet

**Capecitabine**

Pain or peeling affecting daily activity: stop tablets and call.

### 5 Blood / infection

**Capecitabine**

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: contact oncology immediately.

### 6 Hydration / urine

**Capecitabine safety**

Reduced urine, dizziness or inability to drink needs assessment.

### 7 Pelvic skin

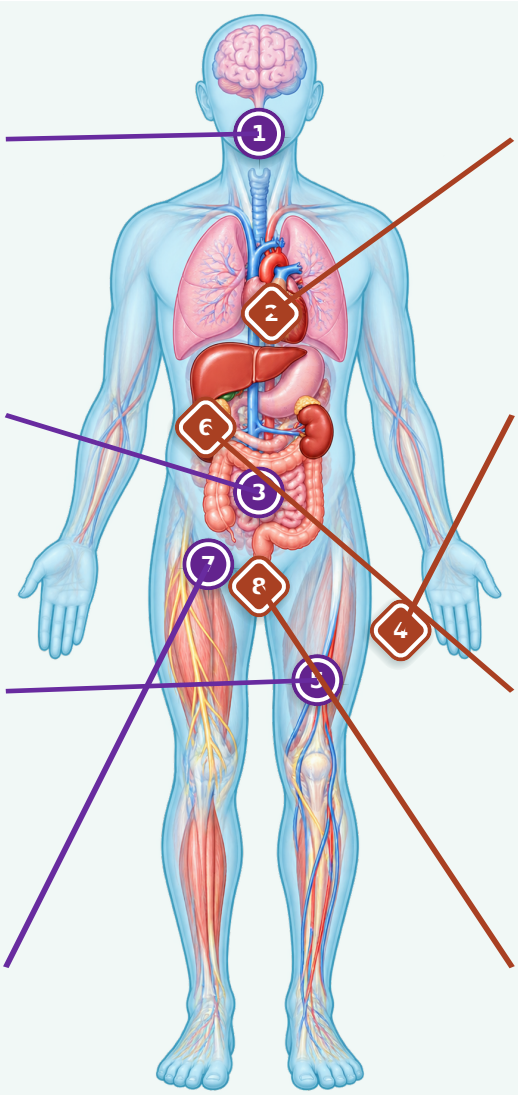
**Radiotherapy**

Report painful, broken or weeping skin in the treatment area.

### 8 Bladder / sexual health

**Radiotherapy**

Report urinary pain and discuss fertility and sexual effects.




Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Stop capecitabine and contact oncology for significant diarrhoea, painful mouth or hand-foot symptoms affecting activity, vomiting that prevents drinking, fever or sudden illness. Do not restart after a toxicity interruption until the team advises.

**When to get help**

**Call 112 / 999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

**Call oncology immediately:** temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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# Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

**FRONT / CONTACTS**

## My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

**Capecitabine + rectal radiotherapy**

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Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

**Daytime (EXAMPLE)** 087 12345678
**Out of hours (EXAMPLE)** 087 87654321

**Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.**
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

CUT outer border

**BACK / TREATMENT RECORD**

## My cycle record

Rolling record — follow your agreed treatment plan.

| Cycle | Date / initials |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

**FOLD centre — do not cut**

## Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

## Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

### iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

### Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

## Your local contacts and resources

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.**

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.


Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.